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PowerShell for Help Desk

Use this when: you fix accounts, services and network problems faster from a prompt than from five consoles.

CompTIA A+ Core 2 · Windows 10/11
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>_ How a command reads

Verb-Noun, then parameters

```
# Verb-Noun -Parameter value | next command
Get-Service -Name Spooler | Restart-Service
Get-Process | Sort-Object CPU -Descending
```

NEVER MEMORIZE: ASK POWERSHELL

Get-Command *dns* find a command
Get-Help Restart-Service -Examples examples
Get-Service | Get-Member see its properties
\$PSVersionTable.PSVersion which version

👤 Accounts

Needs RSAT AD module

Get-ADUser jdoe -Properties LockedOut	Locked?
Search-ADAccount -LockedOut	All locked
Unlock-ADAccount -Identity jdoe	Unlock
Set-ADAccountPassword jdoe -Reset -NewPassword \$pw	Reset
Set-ADUser jdoe -ChangePasswordAtLogon \$true	Force reset

💻 This PC

Get-ComputerInfo	OS and specs
Get-HotFix	Patches
Get-Volume	Free disk space
Get-Service	Services
Get-Process	Processes

🌐 Network

Get-NetIPConfiguration	IP, gateway, DNS
Test-NetConnection 192.0.2.10 -Port 443	Port open?
Resolve-DnsName example.com	DNS answer
Clear-DnsClientCache	Flush DNS

📅 Event logs

```
Get-WinEvent -FilterHashtable
@{LogName='System'; Level=2; StartTime=
(Get-Date).AddHours(-24)} -MaxEvents 20
```

Level 1 critical, 2 error, 3 warning

📋 Ticket recipes

Printer stuck

Restart-Service Spooler

"Did you restart?" (Get-Date) - (Get-CimInstance Win32_OperatingSystem).LastBootUpTime

Disk full Get-Volume | Select-Object DriveLetter, SizeRemaining

☰ Pipeline and remote

```
Get-Service | Where-Object Status -eq 'Stopped'
| Select-Object Name, Status
| Sort-Object Name | Export-Csv stopped.csv
```

Add -WhatIf to preview and -Confirm to ask first.

Enter-PSSession -ComputerName PC01	Remote prompt
Invoke-Command PC01 { Get-Service }	Run remotely

⚠️ Run it safely

⚠️ **DANGER** Never put a password in a script. Set
\$pw = Read-Host -AsSecureString first.

⚠️ **CAUTION** Stop-Process, Remove-Item and
Restart-Computer act at once. Try -WhatIf first.

⚠️ **CAUTION** Read a script before you run it.



REMEMBER

- Open it as **admin** only for admin tasks
- Get-** reads; **Set-** changes
- Tab completes names and parameters